

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 9: THE EARTH (BY H.E. BATES)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"The Earth" is a realistic short story by H.E. Bates. It tells the story of Benjy, a simple-minded boy who begins a poultry business on his doctor's advice. As his business grows, Benjy turns highly cunning, marries against his parents' wishes, and eventually drives them out of their own home.

 15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Who were Johnson and his wife, and what was their main occupation?

Ans: Johnson and his wife were simple, hard-working farmers who lived in a village and earned their livelihood by cultivating a small piece of rented land.

Q2. What kind of boy was Benjy in his childhood?

Ans: In his childhood, Benjy was a simple-minded boy with thick hair and a quiet, vacant look, which made his parents worry constantly about his mental growth.

Q3. What did the doctor advise Benjy's parents to do to help his mind develop?

Ans: The doctor advised them to give Benjy some specific work or responsibility, like keeping and rearing hens, to keep his mind occupied and active.

Q4. How did Benjy start his poultry business initially?

Ans: Benjy started his business with a dozen wire coops and about a dozen hens given by his parents, which he kept at the back of their house.

Q5. What did Benjy's parents do with the money earned from the eggs?

Ans: His parents carefully put every penny earned from the egg sales into a savings bank account, intended to be given to Benjy when he turned twenty-one.

Q6. What happened when Benjy reached the age of twenty-one?

Ans: When Benjy turned twenty-one, his parents held a small ceremony and handed over the bank passbook to him, expecting a word of gratitude.

Q7. How did Benjy react upon receiving his bank passbook?



CLASS - 12th**SUBJECT - ENGLISH****PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH**

Ans: Benjy showed no emotion or gratitude; he simply opened the book, checked the balance, and casually pocketed it without saying a word of thanks.

Q8. What did Benjy do with the large sum of money accumulated in his account?

Ans: Benjy used the accumulated money to buy the plot of land they were renting from Mr. Whitmore, and later bought another piece of land.

Q9. Who was Florence, and why did Benjy's parents dislike her?

Ans: Florence was a girl who came to work at Benjy's poultry farm. His parents disliked her because they found her unattractive, unhygienic, and ill-mannered.

Q10. Why did Benjy decide to marry Florence against his parents' wishes?

Ans: Benjy married Florence because she was a hard worker who helped grow his poultry business, and he prioritized his business needs over his parents' emotions.

Q11. How did the behavior of Benjy change after his marriage to Florence?

Ans: After marriage, Benjy became completely selfish and distant. Under Florence's influence, he began treating his aging parents like unwanted guests in the house.

Q12. How did Benjy divide the household spaces after his marriage?

Ans: Benjy and Florence took over the best rooms of the house for themselves, pushing his parents into a small, uncomfortable back room.

Q13. What final cruel act did Benjy commit against his parents?

Ans: Benjy loaded his old, helpless parents into his Ford van, drove them down to the town, and left them on a pavement, abandoning them forever.

Q14. What lesson does the story "The Earth" teach the readers?

Ans: The story teaches that material greed can destroy human values, and parents should not blindly trust a child's business mind over moral upbringing.

Q15. Why is the title "The Earth" highly significant for this story?

Ans: The title is significant because the entire plot revolves around the ownership of the earth (land), which first supported the parents but finally became the cause of their betrayal.

 50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'The Earth' is a gripping short story written by: (A) Anton Chekhov (B) H.E. Bates (C) Shiga Naoya (D) Guy de Maupassant

2. H.E. Bates was a well-known writer born in: (A) India (B) England / Britain (C) America (D) Australia

3. H.E. Bates was born in 1905 and passed away in the year: (A) 1948 (B) 1968 (C) 1974 (D) 1980

4. The central character of the story 'The Earth' is: (A) Johnson (B) Benjy (C) Sanders (D) Whitmore



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

5. Benjy was the son of: (A) Mr. Sanders (B) Mr. and Mrs. Johnson (C) Mr. Whitmore (D) Dr. Copeland
6. In his early childhood, Benjy was considered to be: (A) a genius (B) simple-minded / dull (C) violent (D) blind
7. Benjy had thick hair and a quiet, vacant look in his: (A) eyes (B) clothes (C) house (D) books
8. Benjy's parents took him to a _____ because they were worried about his mind.: (A) teacher (B) lawyer (C) doctor (D) priest
9. The doctor advised the parents to give Benjy some: (A) medicine (B) books (C) business/responsibility (D) beatings
10. To keep Benjy's mind occupied, the doctor suggested he should keep: (A) dogs (B) hens / poultry (C) cows (D) horses
11. Benjy started his poultry project with about a _____ hens.: (A) hundred (B) dozen (C) thousand (D) five
12. Benjy understood everything about the business of: (A) cars (B) eggs and hens (C) clothes (D) gold
13. The money earned from selling eggs was safely deposited in a: (A) box under the bed (B) savings bank account (C) post office (D) local shop
14. The bank account was opened in the name of: (A) Johnson (B) Benjy (C) Florence (D) Sanders
15. Benjy's parents planned to hand over the money to him when he reached the age of: (A) fifteen (B) eighteen (C) twenty-one (D) twenty-five
16. When Benjy turned twenty-one, his parents gave him his: (A) car keys (B) bank passbook (C) marriage gift (D) new house
17. Upon receiving the passbook, Benjy did not say a word of: (A) anger (B) thanks / gratitude (C) complaint (D) sorrow
18. Benjy used his money to buy the rented land from their landlord named: (A) Mr. Sanders (B) Mr. Whitmore (C) Mr. Bates (D) Mr. Johnson
19. Benjy's parents had been renting their land for more than _____ years.: (A) ten (B) twenty (C) thirty (D) fifty
20. As Benjy's poultry business expanded, the whole ground became covered with hen: (A) feathers (B) coops and houses (C) eggs only (D) food
21. The name of the girl who came to work at Benjy's farm was: (A) Mary (B) Florence (C) Lucy (D) Natalia
22. Benjy's parents disliked Florence because she had bad posture and unhygienic: (A) clothes (B) teeth and appearance (C) talk (D) hair
23. Benjy decided to marry Florence primarily because she was a good: (A) singer (B) worker / helper (C) dancer (D) cook
24. Benjy's parents believed that he should marry a girl from a: (A) city (B) good, respectable family (C) foreign country (D) royal background



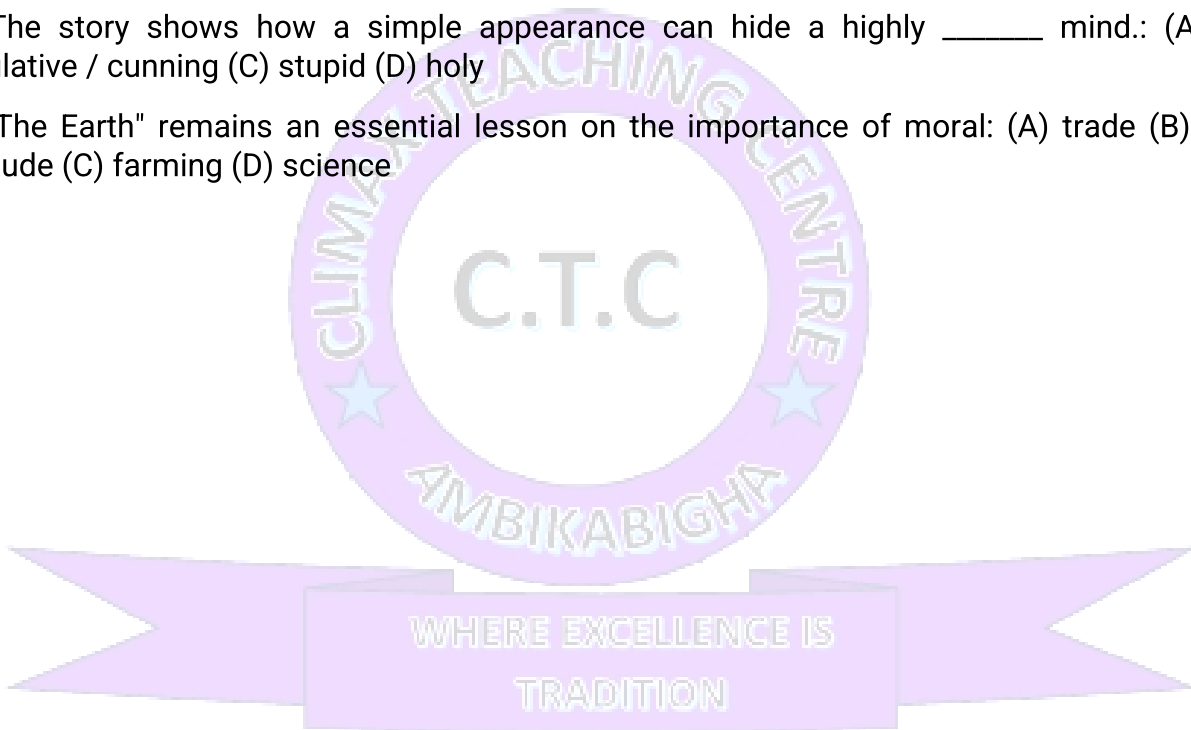
CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

25. After marrying Florence, Benjy became completely: (A) generous (B) selfish and cruel (C) religious (D) poor
26. Florence gradually created a rift between Benjy and his: (A) friends (B) parents (C) doctors (D) customers
27. The old couple was shifted from their large bedroom to a small: (A) kitchen (B) back room (C) stable (D) hotel
28. Benjy bought a small mechanical vehicle which was a: (A) Ford van (B) tractor (C) bicycle (D) motorcycle
29. One day, Benjy coldly told his parents that they must: (A) go to a hospital (B) leave the house / go away (C) buy more hens (D) stop eating
30. Benjy drove his old parents into the town and left them on a: (A) railway station (B) pavement / street (C) park bench (D) hospital gate
31. The story depicts the tragic breakdown of a: (A) business (B) family dynamic / relationship (C) machine (D) poultry farm
32. Johnson was a man who believed too much in luck and: (A) hard work (B) fate / prayers (C) science (D) education
33. Johnson often wasted his time talking and: (A) reading (B) preaching / gossiping (C) painting (D) driving
34. The land bought by Benjy originally belonged to the estate of: (A) Sanders (B) Whitmore (C) Bates (D) King
35. Benjy's eyes lost their simple look and became cunning and: (A) beautiful (B) sharp / business-minded (C) blind (D) sad
36. The script of 'The Earth' is structurally categorized as a/an: (A) essay (B) short story (C) play (D) epic poem
37. Benjy valued his hens more than his own: (A) wealth (B) parents and ethics (C) van (D) land
38. When his parents were left on the street, the weather was: (A) rainy (B) cold and gray (C) hot and sunny (D) snowing
39. The doctor's advice proved to be good for Benjy's wealth but bad for his: (A) body (B) character and morality (C) hens (D) bank balance
40. Benjy's parents never complained against their son because they were too: (A) proud (B) simple and broken-hearted (C) rich (D) angry
41. Florence can be described as a highly shrewd and: (A) innocent girl (B) manipulative woman (C) lazy worker (D) rich heiress
42. The main theme of "The Earth" is material greed versus human: (A) technology (B) relationships / values (C) health (D) politics
43. Benjy's poultry farm eventually became the largest in the: (A) country (B) district / locality (C) town (D) world



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

44. The old parents had spent their entire lives improving the: (A) car (B) soil / earth (C) bank (D) school
45. In the end, Benjy walked away from his parents without looking: (A) up (B) back (C) down (D) ahead
46. The name "Benjy" is a short form for: (A) Benjamin (B) Ben (C) Bennett (D) Benedict
47. The narrative style of H.E. Bates in this story is highly: (A) poetic (B) realistic and clear (C) confusing (D) historical
48. Benjy's parents realized their mistake when it was too: (A) early (B) late (C) funny (D) profitable
49. The story shows how a simple appearance can hide a highly _____ mind.: (A) honest (B) calculative / cunning (C) stupid (D) holy
50. "The Earth" remains an essential lesson on the importance of moral: (A) trade (B) upbringing / gratitude (C) farming (D) science



SUJIT KUMAR

